

	HOLLYWOOD POLICE DEPARTMENT	SOP #228.1
LICENSE PLATE READERS (LPR)		
ORIGINATION DATE: 10/12/2010		REVISED DATE: 05/15/2025
APPROVED: CHIEF OF POLICE, JEFF DEVLIN 		

PURPOSE: To establish criteria for the deployment and use of License Plate Readers (LPR).

SCOPE: This SOP applies to all Sworn Members with authorized access to the License Plate Recognition Systems(s) (LPR)

POLICY: It is the policy of the Hollywood Police Department to utilize the latest technology to support the law enforcement function in identifying and apprehending criminals. License Plate Readers (LPR) utilize computer technology to scan and identify vehicle license plate numbers and letters appearing on selected Hot Lists.

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PROCEDURE:

I. DEPLOYMENT

A. Contributing Factors for Deployment of LPR trailers:

The deployment of LPR trailers is based upon the following factors:

1. Deployment factors include, but are not limited to, crime trends, traffic complaints, supervisor requests, operational needs, and other Departmental needs.

B. Deployment Authority:

1. The Sergeant and Detective(s) assigned to the Real Time Intelligence Center are the liaisons between the Department and the LPR provider(s) and are the designated System Administrators.

C. Deployment Requests for Mobile LPR Trailers:

1. All deployment requests shall be made to the Real Time Intelligence Center Sergeant and/or their designee. A reasonable amount of time should be allotted for coordination. Exigent circumstances will be handled on a case-by-case basis.
2. The requesting Unit/Division will be responsible for having their members deploy/retrieve the LPR trailers in coordination with the Real Time Intelligence Center. It is also the responsibility of the members to account for the wellness and safety of the deployed equipment by regularly checking on its status while it is in the field.

II. OFFICER RESPONSIBILITIES

A. Requirements:

1. All authorized users will ensure that their credentials are up to date and remain active to monitor the LPR Systems.
2. LPR Systems are to be used for law enforcement purposes only.

B. Accountability:

1. The Systems Administrator(s) will continually monitor the automated reporting systems to ensure they are operational and only grant access to trained authorized users.

C. Hot List Alerts:

- a. An audible and visual alarm indicates LPR alerts. Officers must verify all alerts before taking any law enforcement action. Verification starts by visually confirming that the Hot List entry matches the digital image displayed by the LPR. After confirmation is obtained, Officers can take law enforcement action while remaining within Departmental guidelines.
- b. In NCIC/FCIC alerts, Officers will verify the tag information via dispatch before taking law enforcement action.
- c. In Agency-Generated "Hot List" alerts, Officers will utilize the alert to further the operational goals of investigation, crime prevention, and/or deterrence.

III. TRAINING

A. Requirements:

1. Officers will receive initial training for Motorola Solutions and Flock Safety LPR Systems as defined by the System Administrators. Additional online training resources are also available to Officers via their user access accounts for both LPR Systems.

Initial training will include:

- a. Setting up user access accounts
- b. Proper usage guidelines
- c. Reporting requirements
- d. Policy assignment and review via PowerDMS

IV. EQUIPMENT MAINTENANCE

A. Maintenance/Malfunction and Repairs

1. If a malfunction occurs with an LPR system, the System Administrators will be notified.
2. Repairs to a system will only be coordinated by the System Administrators.
3. Members will report damage, vandalism, or anything that would hinder the performance of an LPR system to the designated System Administrators or designee so corrective actions can be coordinated.

V. DATA STORAGE

A. Image capture and retention

1. Motorola Solutions and Flock Safety maintain the LPR system databases. These databases house current hotlists as well as the license plates. The plate scans consist of an image of the vehicle, a close-up view of the license plate, GPS location, and date/time of scan. These images are sorted by the software as either reads or hits. Hits refer to scans that have generated a possible match with one of the active hotlists at the time of the scan. Reads are scans captured but did not produce a match or "hit" from the hotlist.
2. The retention period for all scans is one (1) year for Motorola Solutions and thirty (30) days for Flock Safety.

B. Data Sharing

LPR data captured and stored may be shared with other Criminal Justice Agencies for the purposes of conducting ongoing or continuing criminal investigations and active criminal intelligence operations.

VI. INVESTIGATIVE LICENSE PLATE INQUIRIES

A. Authorization

Investigative searches of captured license plate GPS information will only be conducted for an authorized law enforcement purpose.

VII. REPORTING

A. LPR Alert

When a Member authors an Arrest Affidavit that arose from an LPR alert, language will be included indicating that the LPR system alerted the Member to the vehicle/license plate.

VIII. DEFINITIONS:

A. LICENSE PLATE READER (LPR):

A specialized system consisting of computer equipment and cameras that reads, stores, and checks license plates.

B. LICENSE PLATE READER (LPR) TRAILER:

A specialized system consisting of computer equipment and cameras that reads, stores, and checks license plates. The LPR trailers will be trailed to locations and will remotely connect to the LPR system.

C. HOT LIST:

A list of license plates entered into the National Crime Information Center (NCIC) and the Florida Crime Information Center (FCIC) databases, and agency-generated for law enforcement purposes.

D. GPS:

Global Positioning Satellite location.